

Thought provoking studies that will engage you in God’s word
and challenge what you believe with it.
1Peter 1:15,16, 2Cor 6:17

Ahithophel is Bathsheba’s grandfather.

- In order for this to be true, first we have to prove that either Ammiel (1 Chronicles 3:5) and Eliam (2 Samuel 11:3) are the same man or that Ammiel is an ancestor that came before Ahithophel.
 - But, we can’t prove with the Bible that they are the same man.
 - We also can’t prove that Ammiel is a distant ancestor of Bathsheba.
 - And so at least four possible genealogies emerge from what we are given by scripture.
-

Gershom is Moses’ firstborn to Zipporah.

- There aren’t a lot of mentions of Eliezer and Gershom the sons of Moses.
 - Never does the Bible explicitly state that either Eliezer or Gershom were the firstborn.
-

Zipporah and the Ethiopian woman are two different woman.

- After Zipporah and her sons rejoin Moses with his father in law Reuel/Jethro/Hobab after the exodus from Egypt (Exodus 18:2) they don’t leave: only Jethro departs (Exodus 18:27). Zipporah is both a Cushite and a Midianite. Her ancestry includes a mix of the descendants of Cush the son of Ham the son of Noah and Midian the son of Abraham son of Shem the son of Noah.
-

Drinking alcohol is sin.

- Read both James 1:13,14 and John 2:1-11 very carefully and put them together.
 - There are two usages of the word “tempt” in the Bible. One is to “test/prove” as in Genesis 22:1 and Matthew 4:7 and the other is “to entice to evil” as in Matthew 4:1 and James 1:13,14.
 - The point: God will not, does not, and cannot entice/incite/instigate men to sin.
 - In John 2:8, Jesus commands: “Draw out now, and bear unto the governor of the feast.”
 - Therefore, calling drinking alcohol (in this case wine) sin is the same as accusing Jesus of sinning.
 - Proverbs 31:6 “Give strong drink unto him that is ready to perish, and wine unto those that be of heavy hearts.”
 - We are instructed by God (2 Tim 3:16a, Pro 30:5a) to give “strong drink” (Numbers 28:7 “strong wine”) to those that are ready to die.
 - In the same verse we are also instructed to give wine to those that have a heavy (angry, bitter, chafed, discontented) hearts.
 - If drinking alcohol were sin, why would God give us instructions on it’s appropriate usage?
 - Furthermore, alcohol was a required ingredient for several sacrifices in the law (known as the drink offering): Exo 29:40, Lev 23:13, Num 15:5, 28:7 (strong wine).
 - Genesis 14:18 “And Melchizedek king of Salem brought forth bread and wine: and he was the priest of the most high God.”
 - The very King of Peace himself, God in the flesh, brought wine as a gift for Abraham (Hebrews 7:1-3).
 - Judges 9:13 “And the vine said unto them, Should I leave my wine, which cheereth God and man, and go to be promoted over the trees?”
 - The Holy Ghost, via Jotham’s mouth, testifies that wine cheereth (glad, rejoice, joy, merry) God and man.
-

Nahash (an ancestor of Abigail sister of king David) is the same man as Jesse (king David’s father) or is a former husband of Jesse’s wife or is the name of Jesse’s wife.

- This one shows up seemingly everywhere in Bible notes and also in Rabbinic teachings. 1 Chronicles 2:13-16 is often cited as the proof (if any is even offered).
- If you compare 2 Samuel 17:25 to 1 Chronicles 2:13-16 you may notice that there is no proof that these two men are the same person nor will you find proof of that anywhere else in the Bible.
- There are two other mentions of a Nahash in the Bible, one is an Ammonite king (8 verses) and the other is the city of Nahash (1 verse).
- We can’t prove that Nahash the ancestor of Abigail is the same man as Nahash the Ammonite king.
- We can’t even prove whether the “Nahash” in 2 Samuel 17:25 is male or female.

God will never tell you to do something that His word says not to do.

- In **Exodus 20:13** God commands “**Thou shalt not kill.**”
 - All throughout the conquest of Canaan (**Joshua**), early in king Saul's reign, and all throughout king David's conquests and expansion of Israel (**1 Samuel** → **1 Chronicles**) God repeatedly instructs the children of Israel to destroy *many* different peoples.
 - To destroy is the same as to slay which is the same as to cause to perish which is the same as to cut off (**Est 3:13, 8:11, Eze 25:7**).
 - Phinehas and his descendants are blessed by God for killing two people without even being commanded to do so (**Num 25:7-13**).
 - In **Mark 16:15** God commands “**Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.**” to His disciples, which they fulfilled (**Colossians 1:23**).
 - In **Acts 16:6** Paul and Timothy were “forbidden of the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia”
 - In **Acts 16:7** Paul and Timothy “assayed to go into Bithynia: but the Spirit suffered them not.”
 - **Exodus 20:14** “**Thou shalt not commit adultery.**”
 - **Leviticus 20:10** “**And the man that committeth adultery with another man's wife, even he that committeth adultery with his neighbour's wife, the adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death.**”
 - Read **John 8:1-11**. What is God's command in v7? Is it exactly what He commanded in **Lev 20:10**?
 - In **Esther 8:8** we read that in king Ahasuerus's empire what is written in the king's name cannot be reversed. So, his advice for Esther to save her people is to write a new command in his name. This *seemingly* minor detail about laws in the Persian empire was not put here by God by accident.
 - In your imagination replace the king with God the Father and Esther with Jesus. Now you have a picture of what God did from the Old testament to the New testament. He offered Himself, to save His people. Moreover, that seemingly minor detail is written because it teaches us how God runs His kingdom. Keeping the word of God *includes* any commands that He may give us at any time (by His word, or by His Spirit) (**Ecc 12:13,14**).
-

Working on Sunday is disrespectful/evil/sin.

- Judging someone, for any reason, based on whether they do or don't work on Sunday is sin itself. Moreover, what is considered sin defined by God extends far beyond just that:
 - **Colossians 2:16,17** “**Let no man** therefore **judge you** in meat, or in drink, or in respect of an holyday, or of the new moon, or of the sabbath days: Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body is of Christ.”
 - Take very careful note that that verse covers a lot more than just what we do or don't do on Saturday (**Mar 2:27**) and Sunday (**Rev 1:10**).
 - Notice that the things listed are all of the law (**Heb 10:1**)? **Romans 6:14,15, 10:4, Gal 5:18**.
-

Samuel is of the tribe of Ephraim.

- To prove Samuel's lineage we must take three different genealogies in three different places and put them all together (it's a lot of fun if you like putting puzzles together). You'll need **1 Samuel 1:1,2** and **1 Chronicles 6:22-28, 33-38**. Here are some more pieces that fill out all of his genealogy that was revealed to us: **Gen 11:24, 11:29/17:15, 11:26/Jos 24:2, 21:3, 25:26/38:28, 29:35, 29:34, 46:11, 1 Sam 1:20, 8:2**.
 - The truth is that Samuel is a Ramathite (from the city of Ramah), a Levite (by ancestry), and an Ephrathite (from mount Ephraim). By calling him an Ephrathite and putting that together with **1 Samuel 1:19** we know *which* Ramah Samuel, Elkanah, and Hannah lived in of which there are four that we know of. There is Ramah^{H7414} in the land of Benjamin, a Ramath^{H7414} in the south in Simeon, a Ramah^{H7414} in the north in Asher, and a Ramah^{H7414} in the north in Naphtali.
-

Satan understands or knows God's word better than reborn humans can/do.

- Read **John 8:43-47**
 - There is no truth in him (**John 17:17**).
 - He cannot hear the word of God.
 - He cannot believe the word of God.
- If you don't know God's word **very** well Satan can and will easily *beguile* you into thinking he knows the truth (**Isaiah 14:14b**) but what he says can never be entirely the truth. Regardless, the Holy Ghost knows God's word better than anyone ever will, so let Him be your guide (**John 16:13**).
 - Compare exactly what Satan said in **Matthew 4:6/Luke 4:10,11** to **Psalms 91:11,12**.
 - He takes away “to keep thee in all thy ways” and he adds “at any time”. **Deu 4:2, 12:32, Rev 22:18,19**

Jesus' command in **Mark 16:15** "Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature." applies to every reborn human alive today.

Mark 16:14-18 (cf. **Matthew 28:16-20**, **Luke 24:33-53**)

- ¹⁴ ¶ Afterward **he** appeared unto **the eleven** as they sat at meat, and upbraided **them** with **their** unbelief and hardness of heart, because **they** believed not them which had seen **him** after **he** was risen.
- ¹⁵ And **he** said unto **them**, Go **ye** into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.
- ¹⁶ **He that believeth** and is baptized shall be saved; but he that believeth not shall be damned.
- ¹⁷ And these signs shall follow **them that believe**; In my name shall **they** cast out devils; **they** shall speak with new tongues;
- ¹⁸ **They** shall take up serpents; and if **they** drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt **them**; **they** shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.

Notice that I color coded the pronouns and their respective antecedents. Now, take verse **15 out of its context** and what is the antecedent (noun) to the pronoun "ye"? Anyone and everyone. That's only possible if you take it out of it's context. In their context, both pronouns "ye" and "them" in verse **15** point to the noun (antecedent) "the eleven" in verse **14**.

Moreover, scripture itself also confirms the fulfillment of that specific command in the *past* tense:

Colossians 1:23

If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled, and be not moved away from the hope of **the gospel**, which ye have heard, and **which was preached to every creature which is under heaven**; whereof I Paul am made a minister;

Notice that Paul was a made a minister **to** what was preached. He was not one of the eleven.

Summary of spiritual gifts

1 Corinthians 12:1,8-11

- ¹ Now concerning **spiritual gifts**, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.
- ⁸ For to one is given by the Spirit **the word of wisdom**; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit;
- ⁹ To another **faith** by the same Spirit; to another the **gifts of healing** by the same Spirit;
- ¹⁰ To another the **working of miracles**; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another **divers kinds of tongues**; to another the **interpretation of tongues**:
- ¹¹ But all these worketh that one and the selfsame Spirit, **dividing to every man severally as he will**.

1 Corinthians 12:28-30

- ²⁸ And God hath set some in the church, first **apostles**, secondarily **prophets**, thirdly **teachers**, after that **miracles**, then gifts of healings, helps, **governments**, **diversities of tongues**.
- ²⁹ Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?
- ³⁰ Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?

Ephesians 4:8-12

- ⁸ Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave **gifts** unto men.
- ⁹ (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?
- ¹⁰ He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)
- ¹¹ And he gave **some**, **apostles**; and **some**, **prophets**; and **some**, **evangelists**; and **some**, **pastors and teachers**;
- ¹² For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:

Notice that only **some** are given the gift of evangelism? What do we see in the world today? Are all evangelists? God Himself is the distributor of spiritual gifts and that's exactly what we see Him doing in the world today. We don't get to pick and choose which ones we feel like doing. That's the workings of God and it will go on as He commanded regardless of anything else.

Preaching the gospel is what saves people or people need to hear the gospel or they can't be saved.

- First, know that preaching/proclaiming the gospel is a *work* that men can do (you speak with your mouth; it's an action which is also known as a work). God makes it crystal clear in [Ephesians 2:9a](#) "Not of works". But, let's look at more:
- In [John 8:43-47](#) we learn from Jesus:
 - Unsaved people cannot hear the word of God.
 - Unsaved people cannot believe the word of God.
- Let that sink in because Jesus Himself and his words are the words of God ([John 14:10](#)) and those unbelieving Jews could not hear Him nor could they believe Him ([Isaiah 6:9,10, 29:10-12](#)).
- The King James Bible is also the word of God ([2 Timothy 3:16](#)) and truth ([John 14:6, 17:17](#)) that unsaved people cannot hear, believe, or understand ([1 Corinthians 2:14](#)).
- Why do you think so many unsaved people flock to all the perverse translations of God's word out there? We just read why: because they can't hear, believe or understand God's word. It's foolishness *to them*. So, they go to what is not foolishness *to them* which is *not of God*.
- [Ephesians 2:8-10](#) ⁸ For **by grace** are ye saved **through faith**; **and that not of yourselves**: it is the gift of God: ⁹ **Not of works**, lest any man should boast. ¹⁰ For we are **his workmanship**, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them."
- When it says "*and that not of yourselves*" what do you think it is referring to? The grace or the faith? If you choose only one how can you prove it's only referring to one or the other? As it is written, *both* the grace and the faith are not of ourselves. That teaches us that saving grace and saving faith do not come from any man. So then, where does saving faith come from?
- [Galatians 2:20](#) "...by the faith of the Son of God..."
- A person getting saved is *entirely* the work of God, otherwise someone could boast that they contributed something and that simply has never and will never happen ([Isaiah 42:8](#)).
- If you are more curious *how* God saves a person, Jesus tells us a little more in [John 6:44](#). There are more clues throughout scripture such as [Psalm 19:7](#), but, understandably and for good reasons, we will never fully understand the process this side of eternity. The simple answer is: it's entirely of God and doesn't require anything more than Him which is from everlasting to everlasting.
- How do you think God saves men and woman in parts of the world that never hear God's word? Do you think God didn't have a plan for those people and He just thought "ah well, can't save em all". Foolishness! God knew before the foundation of the world!
- God wants everyone to be saved ([2 Peter 3:9](#)) and He is the only one who could have ever or can ever do anything about it ([Psa 14:2,3, 53:2,3, Rom 3:10,11, John 6:44](#)).
- Where do you think we get the intense desire for people to be saved from? That's God's desire. But, let it be tempered with Wisdom and the word of God.

Misc Topics:

- Tithing is required (false): tithing is of the law, which was the schoolmaster to bring us to Christ that we are no longer under: [Romans 6:14,15, 10:4, Gal 3:10, 5:18, 1 Cor 16:2, 2 Cor 9:7, Mark 12:41-44, Luke 21:1-4, Romans 12:1, Psa 24:1, 1 Cor 6:20, Deu 8:18, Gal 5:9](#).
- Calling spiritual leaders "father" (it is sin): [Matthew 23:8-10](#)
- The practice of celibacy and forbidding certain foods (doctrines of devils): [1 Timothy 4:1-3](#)
- Losing salvation: if you lost it you never had it to begin with because you can't lose what you can't give. This doctrine is for those who believe in works-based salvation which directly contradicts [Ephesians 2:8-10](#). Salvation isn't dependent on anything that people do, it's both the gift and the work of God and it is irrevocable ([Rom 11:29](#)).
- Jesus didn't come in the flesh (a deceiver and an antichrist): [1 John 4:2,3, 2 John 1:7](#)
- The prosperity bad news (it can't be called "gospel" because it's worldly and sinful): [2 Cor 12:9](#)
 - In Hebrews [11](#), the "hall of faith", verse [37](#), the saints of God are described as being "destitute" and immediately following that verse it is said of them "of whom the world was not worthy".
 - [1 John 2:16](#): the prosperity "gospel" falls into all three of these categories that are "not of the Father"
- We're all the children of God (false): [John 8:44](#)
- God loves everyone (false): [John 3:36, Romans 1:18, Eph 5:6, Col 3:6, Rev 14:9-11](#).
- Christmas (Saturnalia, Yule): a poor mimicry of God's goodness to the good and the evil every day. Comes from two traditions of worshiping the sun. God is always good and His mercy endures forever.
- Easter: what do bunnies and eggs have to do with God? Absolutely nothing. Much more so, it's fertility goddess worship (Ashtoreth).
 - The root for the English word "Easter" is the name of an Anglo-Saxon goddess of spring and fertility "Eostre/Ostara".
- Halloween (Samhain, inc. all saints day): witchcraft, familiar spirits, necromancy ([Exodus 22:18, Lev 19:31, 20:6,27, Deu 18:10-12](#)). The wages of sin is death. If it's associated with love of death it is of the love of sin.
- Valentine's day (Lupercalia): fertility and evil spirit warding rituals (wizards, sorcerers, see verses for Halloween)
- Saint John's eve (mixed with sun worship, burning fires which was believed to give strength to the sun)
- May day (sun worship, sorcery), New years day (honor to Janus, a roman god), Lent (it's closely associated with easter; some things "prescribed" are commanded by God to be done at all times or when God commands them, not when we choose, and not how we choose them but exactly how God commanded them).

The word of God preached by man is what gives unsaved people saving faith or faith in God.

- If you haven't already, read the previous topic, especially [John 8:43-47](#) and [Ephesians 2:8-10](#). The faith that saves comes only from God, specifically Jesus after God the Father draws a person to Jesus. Since it can't be saving faith, what is this faith that we read about in [Romans 10:17](#)?
- Who is the epistle (letter) of [Romans](#) addressed to? [Romans 1:1-7](#).
 - [v3a](#) "Concerning his Son Jesus Christ [our Lord...](#)" ([1 Corinthians 12:3](#)).
 - [v6](#) "Among whom are [ye also the called of Jesus Christ:](#)"
 - [v7](#) "[To](#) all that be in Rome, beloved of God, [called to be saints:](#)"
- So, as saints, what kind of faith do we receive when we hear the word of God? Hint: when we read the word of God we hear it in our spirit. You're hearing yourself read this right now. It's the kind of faith that edifies (builds up) *trust* in God.
 - Adam and Eve sinning and God making them coats of skins and preserved them and blessed them.
 - When God rejected Cain's sacrifice He didn't reject him forever – He pleaded with him and taught him a better way.
 - When Lamech learned of Cain and committed murder himself he trusted that God would protect him.
 - Abel offering an acceptable sacrifice long before the law was given
 - Enoch walking with God and His reward was that God took him.
 - Noah building the ark which had no engine or rudder.
 - Noah's family (the seven on the ark with him) trusted Noah because they trusted God.
 - When Hagar left the babe to himself she was giving up and trusting God and He provided.
 - Abram leaving all that he knew and settling in a far away country.
 - Abraham offering the child of the promise on the altar of sacrifice.
 - Abraham pleading for any righteous that might be in Sodom and Gomorrah.
 - The Hebrew midwives breaking the law and God blessed them.
 - Moses carrying the knowledge that God would free the Hebrews by him for at least 40 years.
 - Moses interceding for the children of Israel.
 - Moses commanding God to heal his sister Miriam after she sinned.
 - Aaron holding his peace when two of his sons were devoured by fire from the LORD.
 - Joshua commanding the sun and the moon to stand still.
 - Joseph giving a commandment concerning his bones hundreds of years in advance.
 - Caleb seeing his God bigger than a land of giants and fortified cities.
 - Phinehas thrusting his javelin through a man and a woman to stay the plague.
 - The walls of Jericho.
 - Gideon going to battle without weapons against a significantly overwhelming force.
 - David and the bear, the lion, and Goliath.
 - The kings of Israel and Judah even after God explained to Samuel that they had rejected Him.
 - Zephaniah's pointed justice for the wicked.
 - Ruth's patient endurance leaving her homeland and proposing to Boaz.
 - Jonathan and his armourbearer going up against the Philistine garrison.
 - Nehemiah's immediate response when the king asked him what would he have him do.
 - The rebuilding of Jerusalem even during troublous times.
 - The encouragement of Haggai and Zechariah.
 - Ezra's gentle leadership.
 - Nehemiah's ferocious pursuit of removing evil from the house of God.
 - Mordecai refusing to bow to Haman.
 - Esther going before the king when it was against the law.
 - "Hast thou considered my servant Job"?
 - Solomon's request when God gave him a blank check.
 - Solomon wrote an entire book of what to expect out of a life without God: vanity.
 - The parable of love (Song of Solomon): the love between a man and a woman as a figure of God's unsearchable love for us.
 - Isaiah the faithful scribe delivering God's messages for at least 41 years to a people that God said would not listen.
 - Jeremiah enduring the Babylonian exile.
 - Daniel repeatedly defying the law of the land.
 - Hosea cherishing an adulterous woman.
 - God's persistent pursuit of the perfection of Jonah's heart and leaving the ninety and nine for the lost sheep.
 - Habakkuk's knowledge of impending destruction and his faith in God to provide even during extremely trying times.
 - Simeon patiently waiting for the consolation of Israel amidst a perverse and crooked nation.
 - Peter's jump first, look later mindset and then becoming the first bishop at Antioch, where they were first called Christians.
 - Paul's relentless evangelism, steadfast leadership, and determination through trials no man can endure alone.
 - Timothy's growth from a lad with a faithful mother and grandmother to the first bishop of Ephesus.
 - Philemon's triumphant return to his master.
 - The meekness of Jude.
 - John being exiled to the isle of Patmos to write a summary of and the conclusion to the history of mankind.